

PLAY GREAT SOLO BREAKS!

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #147

What the heck is going on is those burning solo breaks we hear from our heroes? Those amazing flights they take at the end of the melody, right before the beginning of their solos? Clifford Brown and Josh Redman, Louis Armstrong and Trane, Pat Metheny and Bird. I guess they were legends and we aren't, so that's that, huh? HELL NO!

When we understand that a solo break (usually one or two measures long) is just 1) a melody, and 2) a connecting device, everything becomes much more clear. Now the questions become "what shape might my melody have," and "where am I going?" With basic answers to these questions, it all become quite simple. Aim for a harmonic place, and do so by thinking about harmonic progressions that will get you there.

I - I, or V - I, or ii - V - I, or I - VI - ii - V - I, or I - bIII - II - bII - I,
or I - bVII - bVI - V or I - bVI - I, or bVI - I, or

#1 - Cherokee, last four measures

Solo Break

#2 - Clifford Brown solo break on Cherokee

Solo Break

#3 - Solo break, based on I-VI-II-V

Solo Break